

International Collaboration in Animal Behavior:

An analysis of coauthorship in three leading journals

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Methods

On June 12, 2025 we downloaded the bibliographic record of every article published in *Animal Behavior*, *Behavioral Ecology*, and *Behavioral Ecology & Sociobiology* that was indexed in the Web of Science *Core Collection*. These records were then processed and organized using the R package **refsplitr**, with which we also disambiguated author names and visualized author locations and coauthorship networks.

Countries were assigned to Global Regions and National Income Categories using the World Bank categories. Data and Code are available on Github.

Fournier, A., M. E. Boone, F. R. Stevens, and E. M. Bruna. 2020. **refsplitr**: Author name disambiguation, author georeferencing, and mapping of coauthorship networks with Web of Science data. *Journal of Open Source Software*, 5(45), 2028, <https://doi.org/10.21105/joss.02028>

Results

Publications

1. Total No. of Publications (*all journals combined*): N = 23,794

Journal	N
animal behaviour	12471
behavioral ecology	4836
behavioral ecology and sociobiology	6487

2. Publications per Journal

Authors

1. Total No. of Authors (*all journals combined*): N = 27,749

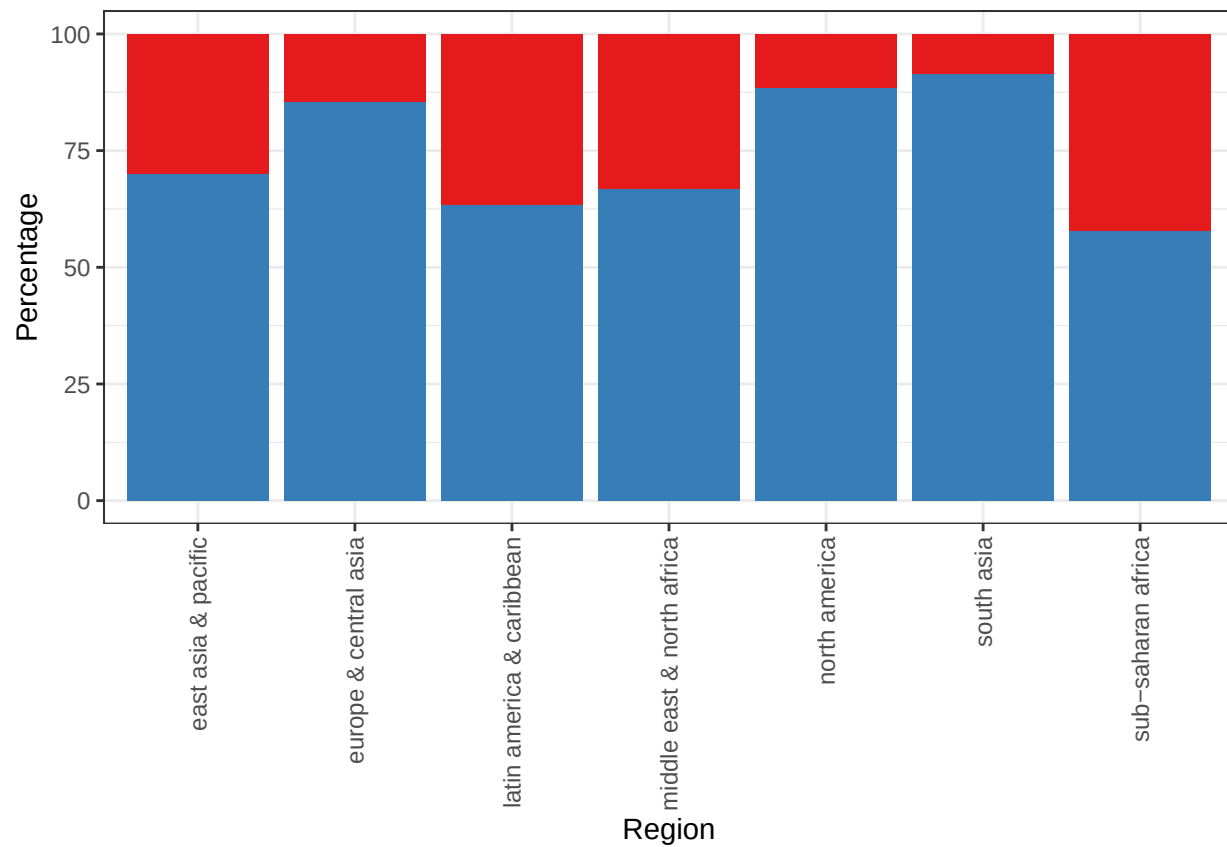
2. In which countries are authors based? Top N = 20 countries (*all journals combined*)

Country (ISO code)	N
usa (usa)	20591
uk (gbr)	6294
canada (can)	5267
germany (deu)	4207
australia (aus)	4133
united kingdom (gbr)	3422
france (fra)	2998
spain (esp)	2010
sweden (swe)	1742
netherlands (nld)	1585
switzerland (che)	1579
italy (ita)	1464
japan (jpn)	1118
finland (fin)	1101
china (chn)	1058
norway (nor)	941
south africa (zaf)	744
israel (isr)	703
brazil (bra)	686
belgium (bel)	676

Coauthorship Analysis (*Note: Only papers with >1 author*)

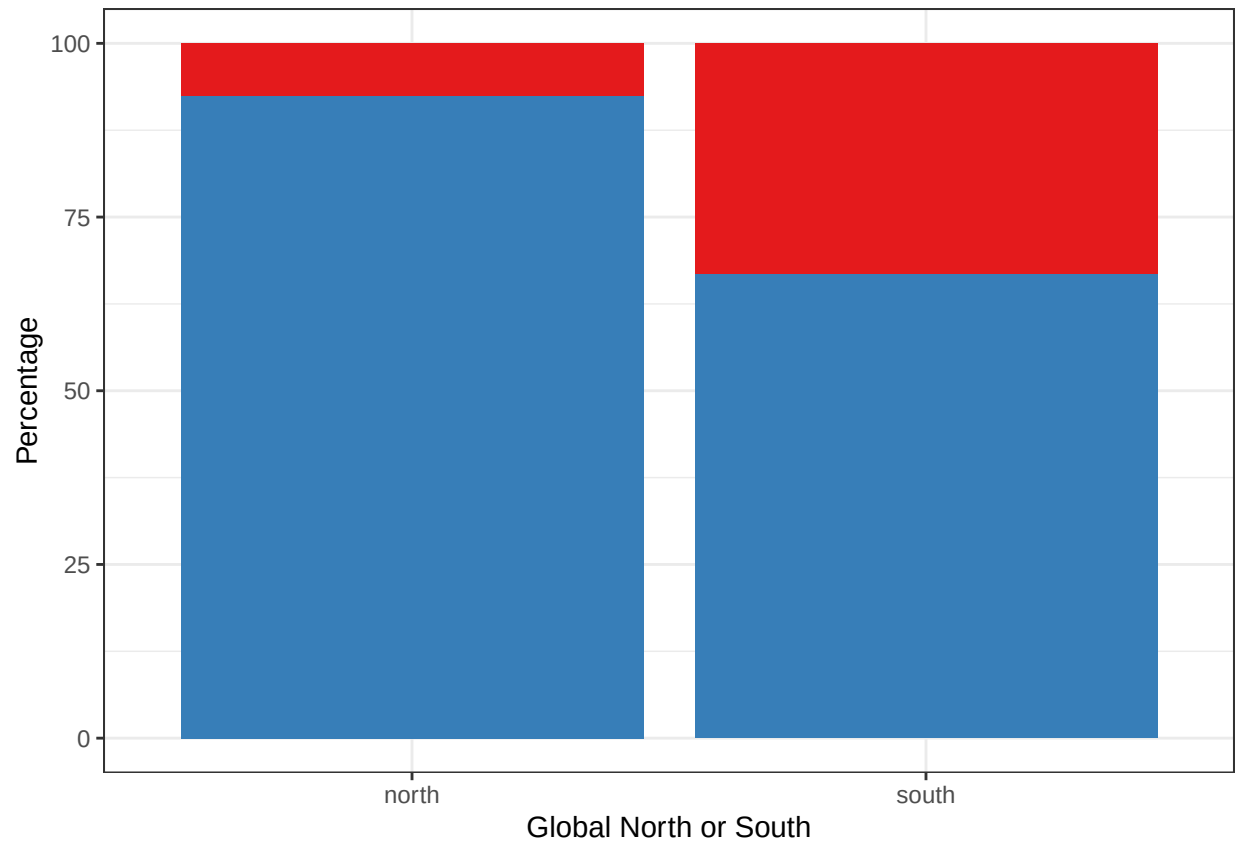
first author based in...	all coauthors in same region	N	%
east asia & pacific	TRUE	1419	70.18
east asia & pacific	FALSE	603	29.82
europa & central asia	TRUE	7396	85.46
europa & central asia	FALSE	1258	14.54
latin america & caribbean	TRUE	340	63.43
latin america & caribbean	FALSE	196	36.57
middle east & north africa	TRUE	145	66.82
middle east & north africa	FALSE	72	33.18
north america	TRUE	6833	88.49
north america	FALSE	889	11.51
south asia	TRUE	86	91.49
south asia	FALSE	8	8.51
sub-saharan africa	TRUE	121	57.89
sub-saharan africa	FALSE	88	42.11

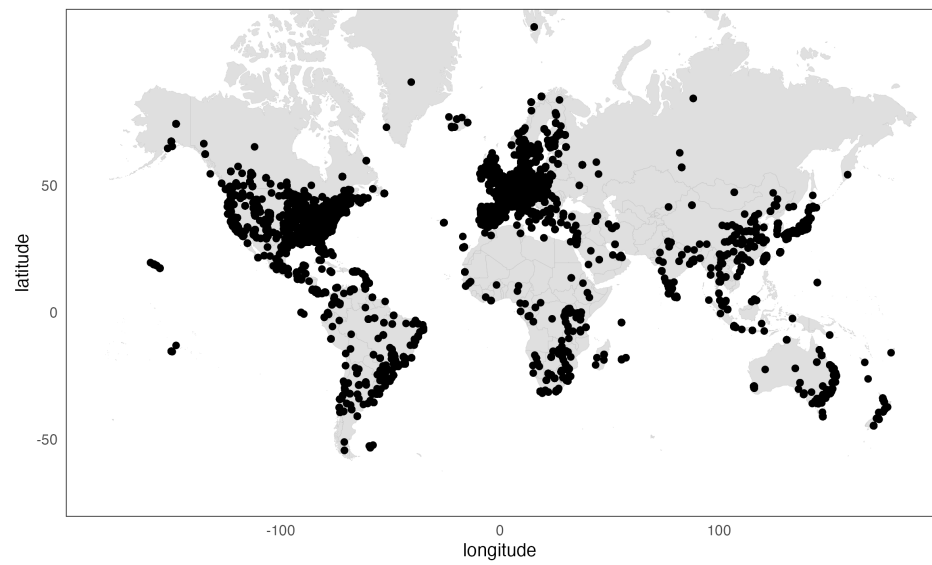
1. Are all co-authors from the same global region as the 1st Author?



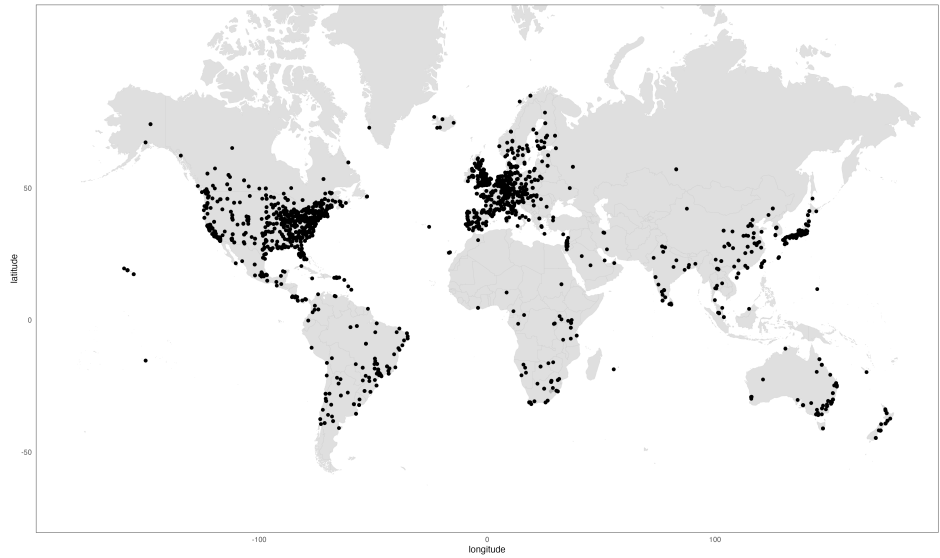
first author based in...	all coauthors in same	N	%
north	FALSE	1393	7.58
north	TRUE	16980	92.42
south	FALSE	426	33.23
south	TRUE	856	66.77

2. Where are the coauthors of papers with 1st authors based in the Global North or South?





All author locations



1st Author Locations

1st Authors based in Latin America & Caribbean

1st Authors based in the USA

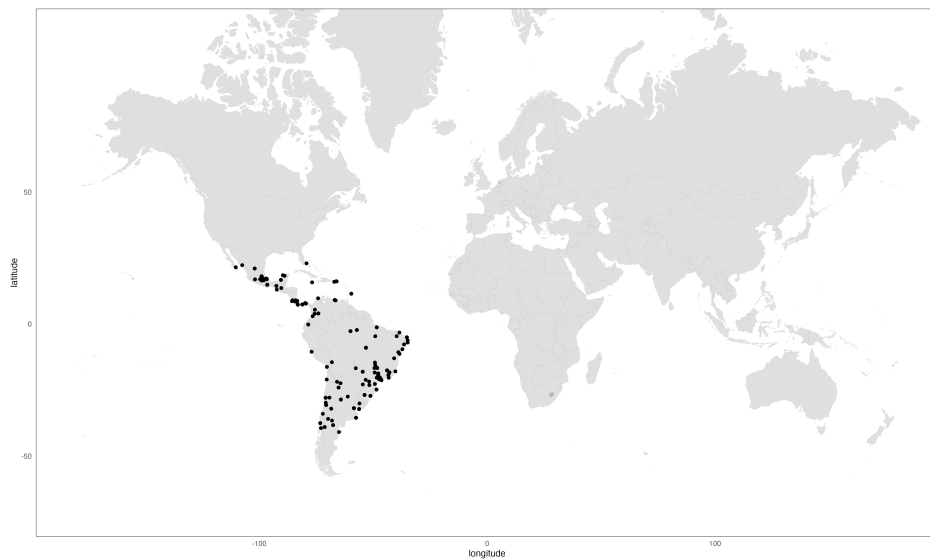


Figure 1: Locations of 1st authors based in Latin America

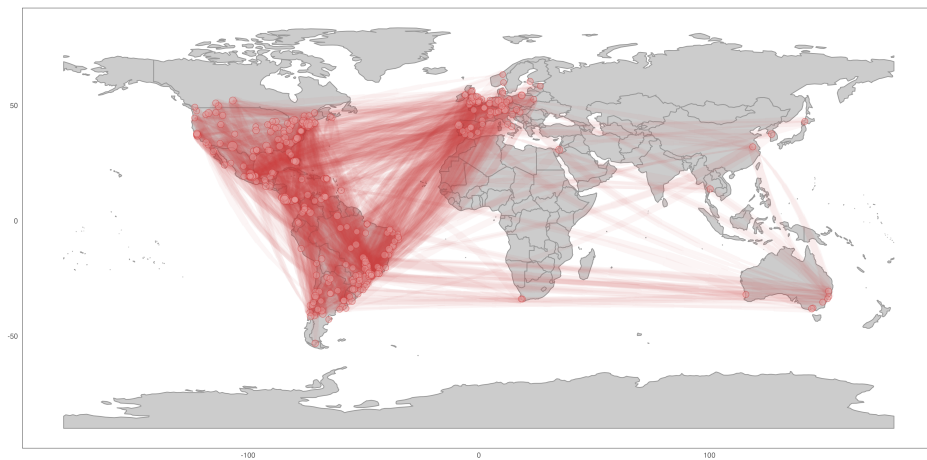


Figure 2: Coauthorship Networks for articles with 1st authors based in Latin America

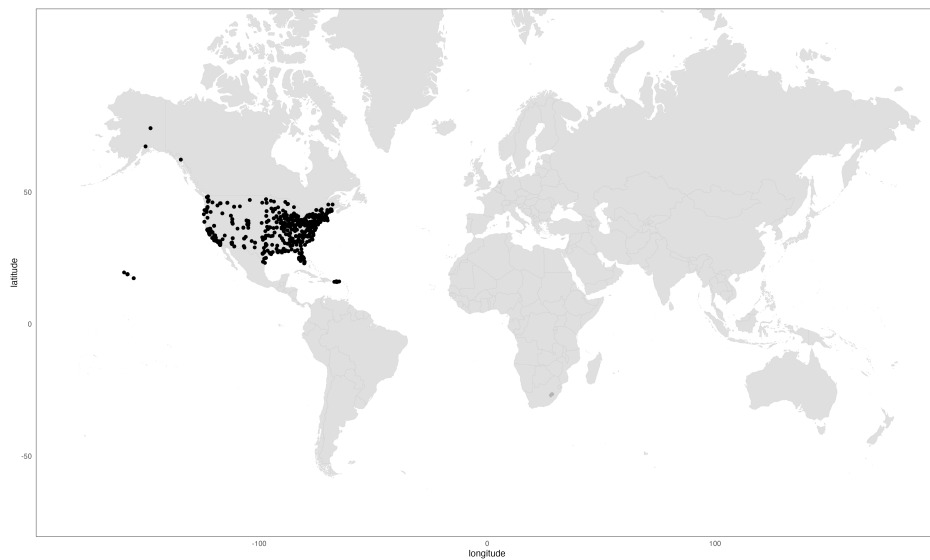


Figure 3: Locations of 1st authors based in USA

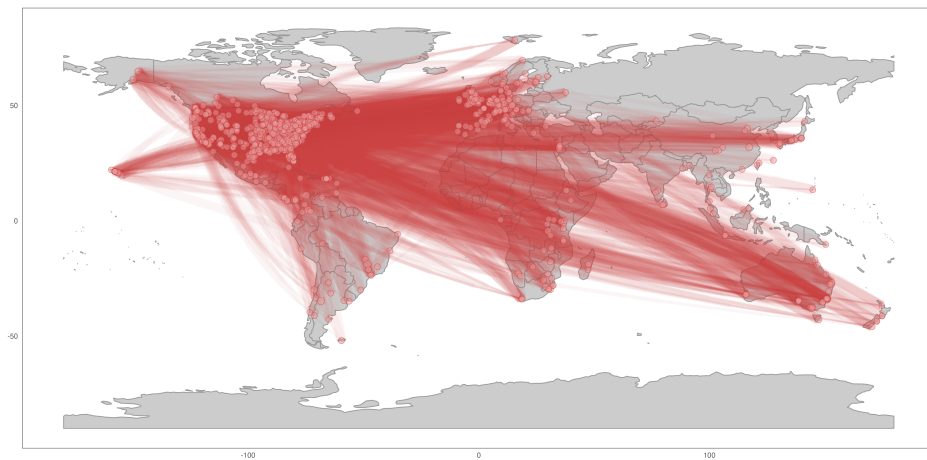


Figure 4: Coauthorship Networks for articles with 1st authors based in USA